Ke Ma

Munich, Germany · +49 152 5901 2691 · ke.ma@kunstgeschichte.uni-muenchen.de · mkarthistory.github.io

ACADEMIC EMPLOYMENT

Research Associate, Doctoral Researcher (from Nov. 2022); **Research Assistant** (2019–2022) Munich · Apr. 2019 – Nov. 2025

Academy project *Corpus of Baroque Ceiling Painting in Germany* (CbDD) · Bavarian Academy of Sciences and Humanities / LMU Munich

- Art-historical research on early modern building culture, historic interiors and room-related pictorial programmes, with a focus on palaces and townhouses
- Archival research and critical evaluation of historical sources for scholarly documentation
- Data modelling, curation and quality assurance in the publication database deckenmalerei.eu; management of the image database (EasyDB, c. 90,000 records)
- Co-design of analogue and digital formats for communicating results at conferences, workshops and public events

EDUCATION

Dr. phil. in Art History (in progress) LMU Munich · since Nov. 2022

Dissertation: *Mapping Chinoiserie: Chinese Cabinets in the Court Architecture of the Holy Roman Empire, ca. 1650–1800*

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Stephan Hoppe

Research on East Asian–European contexts of collections, objects and spaces in the early modern period; archive-based source work, inventory-based collection analysis and modelling of historical furnishing ensembles; study of patterns of diffusion, object circulation and intercultural transfer processes.

M.A. in Art History (grade 1.0 ≈ 100/100) LMU Munich · Oct. 2018 – Jan. 2022

Thesis: *From the Encyclopaedic Kunstkammer to the Porcelain Cabinet: The Collection of Chinese Objects and their Spatial Contexts at Schloss Friedenstein*

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Stephan Hoppe

Focus: history of architecture (c. 1500–1900); digital humanities.

M.A. in Classical Archaeology (in progress, current average 1.6 ≈ 92/100) LMU Munich · since Oct. 2018

Thesis: *Medea and Prokne: Two Tragic Child-Killers in Text and Image*

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Stefan Ritter

Focus: Greek vase painting; image–text analysis; questions of cultural and gender history.

B.A. in Art History (grade 1.7 ≈ 90/100) University of Freiburg · Oct. 2015 – Jun. 2018

Minors: Classical Archaeology; Byzantine Archaeology

FELLOWSHIP

Herzog Ernst Fellowship · Gotha Research Centre, University of Erfurt Gotha · Apr. – Jul. 2026

Project: *Gotha as a Node? East Asian Collection and Furnishing at Schloss Friedenstein: Networks of Collecting, Knowledge and the Imagination of China in their Regional Entanglements*

Examines how collections, books, correspondence and practices of exchange produced a notion of ‘China’ at the Gotha court of the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, and in which relations, through which materials and on what level Gotha becomes a node for chinoiserie in Thuringia.

MEMBERSHIPS

German Association of Art Historians · Working Group Digital Art History · Renaissance Society of America

RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Early modern courtly architecture and interiors; craft knowledge and building practice at court
- Collection spaces and chinoiserie cabinets in palaces of the Holy Roman Empire (c. 1650–1800)
- Transcultural art history; the history of collecting and early modern collection theory
- Historical social networks; digital and network-based approaches to the history of architecture and interior decoration
- Digital documentation and recontextualisation of dispersed and lost collections

PUBLICATIONS

— Ma, Ke. ‘Staging Otherness: Mirrors, Optical Illusion, and East Asian Fantasy in Eighteenth-Century Chinoiserie Rooms – With a Focus on the Mirror-Porcelain Cabinet at Gotha’. In *Historic Spaces and Multisensory Experience: A Digital Exploration of Light, Sound, and Movement*, ed. Stephan Hoppe and Matteo Burioni. Berlin: De Gruyter, 2026 (forthcoming).

— Ma, Ke. ‘Das verlorene Lusthaus der Münchner Residenz’ [The Lost Pleasure House of the Munich Residenz]. In *Digitale Raumdarstellung: Barocke Deckenmalerei und Virtual Reality* [Digital Spatial Representation: Baroque Ceiling Painting and Virtual Reality], ed. Stephan Hoppe, Hubert Locher and Matteo Burioni, Computing in Art and Architecture 4, 256–87. Heidelberg: arthistoricum.net, 2020. https://doi.org/10.11588/arthistoricum.774.c10132

CONFERENCE PAPERS AND TALKS

Accepted

— ‘Made in China, Made at Court? A Graph-Based Analysis of Historical Constellations in Chinoiserie Cabinets of the Holy Roman Empire (1650–1800)’. Poster, DHd 2027 – *Mind the Gap!*, University of Marburg, 1–5 Mar. 2027.

— ‘Who Fears the Murderous Mother? Medea and Prokne between Greek Tragedy and Visual Culture’. TARTALO – 10th International Conference on Myth in the Arts, Universidad del País Vasco / EHU, Vitoria-Gasteiz, 17–20 Nov. 2026.

— ‘From Property Graphs to Split Networks: Style Affinities and Variation in Early Modern Chinoiserie Interiors’. CHNT31 – Conference on Cultural Heritage and New Technologies, Orangerie Schönbrunn, Vienna, 11–13 Nov. 2026.

Delivered

— ‘“… many idols carved from soapstone …”: On the Spatial Recontextualisation of Soapstone Carvings in Late-Baroque Chinoiserie Cabinets’. Conference *Applied Arts: Current Perspectives on a Multifaceted Field of Research*, Herzog Anton Ulrich-Museum Braunschweig / Hessen Kassel Heritage, 28–30 Oct. 2026.

— ‘Mapping Chinoiserie: A Data-Modelling Approach to Chinese Cabinets in the Court Architecture of the Holy Roman Empire, ca. 1650–1800’. The Connected Past 2026, University of Toronto, 22–25 Sept. 2026.

— ‘Tracking Porcelain, Reconstructing Lost Rooms: Collection History, Dynastic Tradition, and Regional Courtly Display in Baden-Durlach’. Heritage(s), AMPS, Istanbul, 6–8 Jul. 2026.

— ‘Exotic Thuringia? Gotha as a Node: China-Related Knowledge Networks, Courtly Collecting Practices and the Regional Formation of a Chinoiserie Style’. Colloquium Intellectual History, Gotha Research Centre, 9 Jun. 2026.

— ‘Hidden Connections and Local Style Genesis: Late-Baroque Chinoiserie and Knowledge Networks in Eighteenth-Century Palaces in Thuringia and Beyond’. Rudolstadt Working Group on Court Culture, Gotha City Library, 11 May 2025.

— ‘Research Data in the Corpus of Baroque Ceiling Painting’. Online Forum Data Literacy, Cultural Research Data Academy (NFDI4Culture), Edirom Summer School, 25 Sept. 2024.

— ‘Reflection and Elegance: The Use of Mirrors in Late-Baroque Porcelain Collection Rooms’. Workshop *Historic Spaces and Multisensory Experience*, LMU Munich, 12 Oct. 2023.

TEACHING

Teaching assistant, Institute of Art History, LMU Munich

Digital Cultural Heritage, practical course — PD Dr. Matteo Burioni · Summer 2025
Sessions on semantic databases; image databases and Creative Commons licences; AI applications; 3D models.

The Early Modern Period, survey lecture — Prof. Dr. Stephan Hoppe · Summer 2020
Accompanying tutorial on European art, c. 1400–1800.

Late Renaissance Architecture in 3D:
Digital Reconstruction as a Tool of Art History, seminar — Prof. Dr. Stephan Hoppe · Summer 2019
Introduction to Cinema 4D; sessions on ceiling painting and interior decoration.

Early Modern Art Theory, seminar — PD Dr. Matteo Burioni · Summer 2019
Close reading of sources (Alberti, Vasari, Bellori et al.).

WORKSHOPS AND TRAINING

Network Science Workshop with Gephi and RStudio, The Connected Past 2026 — Toronto · 22–23 Sept. 2026

Belvedere Summer School 2026: ‘Collection Institutions in a Digital World’ — Vienna / Linz · 7–12 Sept. 2026
Belvedere Research Center; Ars Electronica; University of Leicester; University for Continuing Education Krems

The LIDO Format as a Standard for Describing Cultural Heritage Objects, NFDI4Culture — online · 2026

Historical Data Hacking: digital tools for opening up historical datasets — Marburg · 26–28 Nov. 2025
German Documentation Center for Art History – Bildarchiv Foto Marburg

nodegoat: workshop on data management, analysis and visualisation of historical data — Munich · 16 Feb. 2023
Institute of Contemporary History, Munich–Berlin

Databases and Network Research on Sixteenth-Century Building Accounts — Munich · 14–15 Feb. 2022
Institute of Art History, LMU Munich

COMPETENCES

Languages	Chinese (native) · German (C2) · English (C1–C2) · Latin (advanced) · Italian and Ancient Greek (basic)
Archival work	Palaeography and transcription; HTR model training (Transkribus) and information extraction
Data modelling	Semantic data modelling; property graphs (Neo4j), Wikibase, nodegoat; CIDOC CRM, LIDO
Network analysis	Graph databases; network analysis and visualisation (Gephi); split networks (SplitsTree)
Collections	Collection documentation; digital asset management (EasyDB); image rights and licensing
AI workflows	AI workflows for structuring archival sources, keeping evidence and interpretation apart
3D and media	3D reconstruction (Cinema 4D, Blender); photogrammetry; Adobe Creative Cloud; Final Cut Pro
Programming	Python (basic); HTML, CSS, JavaScript (basic); Microsoft 365
Cultural work	Exhibition and event organisation; international project work; translation and interpreting (CN, DE, EN)